NETI ALL INDIA MOCK TEST – 1

SOLUTIONS

GS Paper I | 3rd May 2026

Less noise. More clarity.

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LESS NOISE, MORE CLARITY

HOW TO USE THIS DOCUMENT

- Do not jump to the answer key the moment you finish the test. Sit with the questions you were unsure of and decide what you would have marked. Confidence is data — track it.
- When you check, focus on WHY you got it wrong, not what the right answer was. The correct fact is forgettable; the wrong reasoning is the pattern that will repeat.
- Every elimination mistake — every option you eliminated wrongly — matters more than every fact you missed. Note the pattern. UPSC traps repeat across years.
- Revise concepts, not facts. If you got an Article 32 question wrong, fix your understanding of writ jurisdiction; do not just memorise the answer to this question.
- Skim the source line for each question. If the same source keeps appearing across your wrong answers, that is your weakest preparation area — go there.

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ANSWER KEY

Quick reference. Highlighted cells show the correct option.

Q1–Q10	Q11–Q20	Q21–Q30	Q31–Q40	Q41–Q50
Q1. (B)	Q11. (C)	Q21. (A)	Q31. (B)	Q41. (B)
Q2. (B)	Q12. (B)	Q22. (B)	Q32. (A)	Q42. (A)
Q3. (C)	Q13. (C)	Q23. (B)	Q33. (B)	Q43. (C)
Q4. (B)	Q14. (B)	Q24. (A)	Q34. (D)	Q44. (C)
Q5. (C)	Q15. (C)	Q25. (C)	Q35. (B)	Q45. (C)
Q6. (C)	Q16. (B)	Q26. (D)	Q36. (B)	Q46. (C)
Q7. (C)	Q17. (A)	Q27. (A)	Q37. (B)	Q47. (B)
Q8. (C)	Q18. (B)	Q28. (C)	Q38. (C)	Q48. (B)
Q9. (C)	Q19. (A)	Q29. (C)	Q39. (C)	Q49. (C)
Q10. (A)	Q20. (B)	Q30. (B)	Q40. (B)	Q50. (C)

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ANSWER KEY · Q51 – Q100

Q51–Q60	Q61–Q70	Q71–Q80	Q81–Q90	Q91–Q100
Q51. (B)	Q61. (C)	Q71. (A)	Q81. (A)	Q91. (B)
Q52. (D)	Q62. (C)	Q72. (A)	Q82. (A)	Q92. (B)
Q53. (C)	Q63. (C)	Q73. (B)	Q83. (B)	Q93. (D)
Q54. (C)	Q64. (C)	Q74. (B)	Q84. (C)	Q94. (B)
Q55. (B)	Q65. (A)	Q75. (A)	Q85. (B)	Q95. (A)
Q56. (C)	Q66. (C)	Q76. (C)	Q86. (C)	Q96. (C)
Q57. (A)	Q67. (A)	Q77. (A)	Q87. (B)	Q97. (C)
Q58. (B)	Q68. (A)	Q78. (C)	Q88. (B)	Q98. (B)
Q59. (C)	Q69. (B)	Q79. (D)	Q89. (A)	Q99. (B)
Q60. (C)	Q70. (B)	Q80. (A)	Q90. (B)	Q100. (D)

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DETAILED SOLUTIONS

Q1 – Q100

Q1. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Article 32 is confined to FR enforcement as its gravamen — that is the settled position. Article 226 is wider (any legal right) and the High Court's writ jurisdiction is itself part of basic structure (L. Chandra Kumar, 1997). Both statements are independently correct; II describes a different forum, not the reason for the limit on Article 32, so it does not explain I.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — II is about HC jurisdiction, not the cause of the Article 32 restriction. The link is parallel, not causal.
- (c) — Statement-II is correct law. Parliament cannot oust HC writ jurisdiction without touching basic structure.
- (d) — Statement-I is the textbook position on Article 32 — FR enforcement is its gravamen.

SOURCE

Laxmikanth, ch. on Writ Jurisdiction; L. Chandra Kumar v. Union of India (1997).

Q2. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statement 1 is the textbook position on Article 163. Statement 2 reflects the first proviso to Article 200 — on re-passage the Governor 'shall not withhold assent therefrom'. Statement 3 is wrong: Governor's pardon power under Article 161 is a parallel power and does extend to death sentences imposed under State law (Maru Ram, Kehar Singh).

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — too narrow; statements 1 and 2 are both correct.
- (c) — statement 3 confuses Article 72 (which is exclusive only for court-martial sentences and certain Union-law death sentences) with a blanket exclusion that does not exist.
- (d) — at least two statements are correct; (d) cannot be the answer.

SOURCE

Laxmikanth, ch. on Governor; Constitution, Articles 161, 163, 200.

Q3. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statement 1 lists the three Article 108 grounds correctly, including the six-month inaction clause. Statement 3 reflects Article 108(4). Statement 2 is the trap — the order of presiding is Speaker → Deputy Speaker → Deputy

Chairman of Rajya Sabha → such other member as the House determines. The Chairman of Rajya Sabha never presides over a joint sitting.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — statement 2 is wrong on who presides; eliminate immediately.
- (b) — same reason; statement 2 included.
- (d) — only statements 1 and 3 are correct.

SOURCE

Constitution, Articles 108 and 118; Laxmikanth, ch. on Parliament.

Q4. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statement-I follows from State of Madras v. Champakam Dorairajan and the well-settled non-justiciability of DPSPs. Statement-II is from Minerva Mills (1980) — DPSPs cannot be used to destroy the core of FRs even by amendment. Both are correct, but they describe different propositions; II does not explain why DPSPs are non-justiciable, so the explanation link fails.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — explanation link is missing; II is about FR-DPSP balance, not non-justiciability.
- (c) — Minerva Mills makes Statement-II correct law.
- (d) — non-justiciability of DPSPs is settled; Statement-I is correct.

SOURCE

Laxmikanth, ch. on DPSP; Minerva Mills v. Union of India (1980).

Q5. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three are correct. Article 359 read with the 44th Amendment exempts Articles 20 and 21 from suspension. Article 358 automatically suspends Article 19 only when the Emergency is on the ground of war or external aggression (44th Amendment narrowed this). Articles 20 and 21 are non-derogable — Parliament cannot create exceptions even during Emergency.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — all three statements stand on the post-44th Amendment text.
- (b) — same; eliminate.
- (d) — none of the statements is wrong.

SOURCE

Constitution, Articles 358, 359; Laxmikanth, ch. on Emergency Provisions.

Q6. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statement-I correctly states the Article 109 procedure for Money Bills. Statement-II is the trap — Speaker's certification under Article 110(3) is not absolute. The Supreme Court in Rojer Mathew (2019) held that the certification IS subject to limited judicial review. The 'in any circumstances' qualifier breaks the statement.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — depends on II being correct; it is not.
- (b) — same; II is wrong.
- (d) — Article 109 procedure for Money Bills is correctly stated in I.

SOURCE

Constitution, Articles 109, 110; Rojer Mathew v. South Indian Bank (2019).

Q7. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 3 reflect the CAG's audit jurisdiction and reporting structure correctly. Statement 2 is the trap — since 1976, the function of compiling Union accounts has been separated from the CAG and handed to the CGA (Controller General of Accounts). The CAG today is purely an audit authority, not a compiler.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — includes statement 2, which is historically correct only pre-1976.
- (b) — same; statement 2 is wrong.
- (d) — strict reading of statement 2 fails on the post-1976 separation.

SOURCE

Laxmikanth, ch. on CAG; Article 149; CGA Charter.

Q8. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three pairs match the standard description of these writs. Note that mandamus does extend to private bodies discharging a public duty (Anadi Mukta Trust line of cases). Quo warranto applies only to a public office of substantive character — not to private or honorary posts.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — both undercount; all three definitions are correct.
- (d) — clearly wrong; the textbook descriptions hold.

SOURCE

Laxmikanth, ch. on Writs; Anadi Mukta Sadguru Trust v. V.R. Rudani (1989).

Q9. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statement-I is correct on Article 244 read with the Fifth Schedule and PESA's intent. Statement-II's substance is broadly right, but the absolutist framing — 'cannot, in any circumstances, be diluted by State legislation enacted under Article 243G' — is the trap. State laws for Scheduled Areas operate under the proviso to Article 243M (not 243G), and the absolute claim is too strong.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — depends on II being correctly framed; the article reference is wrong.
- (b) — same; the qualifier 'in any circumstances' is the giveaway.
- (d) — Statement-I is the textbook reading of PESA's constitutional basis.

SOURCE

Constitution, Articles 243M, 244; PESA Act, 1996; Laxmikanth, ch. on Scheduled Areas.

Q10. Correct Answer: (a)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Only Statement 2 is correct (Article 243ZD, DPC). Statement 1 is wrong — Article 243S makes Ward Committees mandatory only for municipalities with a population of 3 lakh or more, not 'irrespective of population'. Statement 3 is wrong — the Twelfth Schedule is enabling; devolution under Article 243W is a 'may', not a 'shall'.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (b) — overcounts; statements 1 and 3 are both qualifier traps.
- (c) — same; only one is correct.
- (d) — incorrect; statement 2 is correct law.

SOURCE

Constitution, Articles 243S, 243W, 243ZD; Twelfth Schedule.

Q11. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statement 1 is the post-44th Amendment requirement (written Cabinet recommendation). Statement 3 is the special-majority requirement under Article 352(6). Statement 2 is wrong — Article 250(2) provides that laws made by Parliament on State List subjects during NE continue for six months after the Proclamation ceases; they do not lapse instantly.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — include statement 2, which is the classic trap on continuance period.
- (d) — statement 2 is wrong; not all three.

SOURCE

Constitution, Articles 250, 352, 358; Laxmikanth, ch. on Emergency.

Q12. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Pairs 1 and 2 are correct. Pair 3 is wrong — the 101st Amendment introduced GST but did NOT subsume basic customs duties, which remain levied by the Union outside GST. Entry tax and several State-level cesses were subsumed; customs were not.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — undercounts; two are correct.
- (c) — overcounts; customs were not subsumed.
- (d) — pairs 1 and 2 are textbook accurate.

SOURCE

Constitution (101st Amendment) Act, 2016; CBIC GST FAQ.

Q13. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statement-I is the text of Article 262(2). Statement-II is the trap — the ISWD Act bars only the Article 131 original jurisdiction. The Supreme Court has consistently entertained Special Leave Petitions under Article 136 against Tribunal awards (Cauvery, Krishna). The blanket bar 'including Article 136' is wrong.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — depend on II being correct; Article 136 is not barred.
- (d) — Statement-I is direct text of Article 262.

SOURCE

Constitution, Article 262; Inter-State River Water Disputes Act, 1956.

Q14. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 2 are textbook Article 324(5). Statement 3 is the trap — the Model Code of Conduct is NOT a statutory document. It evolved through consensus among parties; the ECI enforces it through moral authority, not under any express RPA provision. Treating it as 'statutorily enforceable' is wrong.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (c) — include statement 3, which misstates the legal status of MCC.
- (d) — only two are correct.

SOURCE

Constitution, Article 324; ECI Compendium on MCC.

Q15. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statement-I is the text of Article 280. Statement-II is wrong on two counts: FC recommendations are advisory, not binding (the Constitution does not bind the Union to any specific scheme); and there is no constitutional bar on the Union departing from accepted recommendations — historically the Union has departed from vertical-share recommendations in some years.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — depend on II being correct; binding character is overstated.
- (d) — Article 280 directly supports Statement-I.

SOURCE

Constitution, Article 280; Sarkaria/Punchhi Commission Reports on FC.

Q16. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Both statements are correct. Statement-I describes the well-known monetary transmission lag — bank-level rigidities slow pass-through. Statement-II is the formal MPC accountability rule (RBI Act, 1934 amended 2016, read with the framework agreement). They describe different aspects of the policy framework, so II does not explain I.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — explanation link is absent; the two statements address different issues.
- (c) — MPC's three-quarter rule is correctly stated.
- (d) — transmission lag is well-documented in RBI policy reviews.

SOURCE

RBI Act, 1934 (Sec. 45ZN); Monetary Policy Framework Agreement, 2016.

Q17. Correct Answer: (a)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is the classic trap — CRR balances earn NO interest from the RBI; this is a defining feature distinguishing CRR from SLR. The wording 'market-linked interest' is the giveaway.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (b), (c), (d) — all include statement 3, which is wrong on the no-interest rule.

SOURCE

RBI Master Direction on CRR; Banking Regulation Act, 1949.

Q18. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Pairs 1 and 2 match. Pair 3 is wrong — PFRDA regulates the National Pension System and the Atal Pension Yojana, but NOT the Employees' Provident Fund. The EPF is regulated by the EPFO under the Ministry of Labour and Employment.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — undercounts; two pairs are correct.
- (c), (d) — overcount; PFRDA does not regulate EPF.

SOURCE

PFRDA Act, 2013; EPF & Misc. Provisions Act, 1952.

Q19. Correct Answer: (a)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 2 are textbook. Statement 3 is the trap — fiscal deficit + revenue surplus implies the entire borrowing is for capex, but it does NOT imply zero primary deficit. Primary deficit = fiscal deficit minus interest payments; revenue surplus says nothing about the interest component. The two definitions are independent.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (b) — includes statement 3, which is the conceptual trap.
- (c), (d) — same.

SOURCE

NCERT Macroeconomics, ch. on Government Budget; Indian Public Finance Statistics.

Q20. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 3 are correct (destination principle; three-fourths weighted majority with 1/3 Centre and 2/3 States). Statement 2 is the trap — alcohol for human consumption is constitutionally excluded (Art. 366(12A)) and the GST Council CANNOT bring it under GST without a constitutional amendment. The phrase 'any of them' overreaches.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (c) — include statement 2; alcohol is outside Council's purview.
- (d) — overcounts.

SOURCE

Constitution, Article 279A; CBIC GST FAQ; CAG GST Compendium.

Q21. Correct Answer: (a)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Both statements are correct. Statement-I is factual on the 2014 shift and the 2016 institutionalisation. Statement-II provides exactly the rationale for choosing CPI over WPI — services coverage and cost-of-living relevance. II is therefore the correct explanation of I.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (b) — explanation link is genuine here; II tells you WHY CPI was chosen.
- (c) — services-and-cost-of-living rationale is the standard textbook reason.
- (d) — the 2014 shift and 2016 amendment are well-documented.

SOURCE

RBI Annual Report; Urjit Patel Committee Report (2014); RBI Act, 1934.

Q22. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 2 and 3 are textbook. Statement 1 is the trap — even excluding oil, India typically runs a merchandise trade deficit because of gold, electronics and machinery imports. The 'in most years would record a surplus' claim is empirically false.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (c), (d) — all include statement 1, which fails on actual trade data.

SOURCE

RBI Bulletin on India's BoP; Economic Survey, ch. on External Sector.

Q23. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is the trap — NDS-OM is the secondary market trading platform; primary auctions of G-Secs are conducted on E-Kuber, the RBI's auction platform. The two systems are distinct.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (c), (d) — include statement 3, which conflates NDS-OM with E-Kuber.

SOURCE

RBI website on G-Sec market infrastructure; FIMMDA Handbook.

Q24. Correct Answer: (a)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 2 are correct under the current PSL Master Directions. Statement 3 is the trap — the PSLC mechanism transfers the certificate ONLY; the underlying loan stays on the originating bank's books. There is no transfer of the loan along with the certificate.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (b), (c), (d) — include statement 3, which misreads the PSLC architecture.

SOURCE

RBI Master Direction on PSL; RBI PSLC Operational Guidelines.

Q25. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three pairs reflect the standard IMF facility taxonomy. SBA is short-term and non-concessional; EFF is medium-term for structural BoP issues; PRGT is the umbrella for IMF concessional lending to LICs.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — undercount; all three are textbook accurate.
- (d) — clearly wrong.

SOURCE

IMF Factsheet on Lending Facilities (2024).

Q26. Correct Answer: (d)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statement-I is wrong — only Deposit-taking NBFCs (NBFCs-D) can accept public deposits; the very large category of NBFCs-ND cannot. The blanket 'all NBFCs are permitted' is the giveaway. Statement-II is correct — DICGC insurance does NOT cover NBFC deposits.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — depend on Statement-I being correct; it is not.
- (c) — Statement-II is correct, so cannot be (c).

SOURCE

RBI NBFC Master Directions; DICGC Act, 1961.

Q27. Correct Answer: (a)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Only statement 3 is unambiguously correct. Statement 1 inverts the definition (primary market = new issuance, not investor-to-investor trading). Statement 2 is the trap — the 35% retail reservation applies only to the book-built route via QIB pathway under Rule 31; for the compulsory book-build route (where the issuer doesn't meet profitability tests), retail reservation is only 10%. The phrase 'irrespective of the route' breaks the statement.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (b), (c), (d) — all overstate. The route-conditionality of retail reservation is the trap.

SOURCE

SEBI ICDR Regulations, 2018; SEBI Investor Education Material.

Q28. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Cash on hand, gold (at not more than market price) and approved Central and State Government securities all qualify as SLR-eligible assets. AAA-rated corporate bonds are NOT SLR-eligible — only sovereign and approved securities count.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — undercount the eligible categories.
- (d) — overcounts; corporate bonds are excluded.

SOURCE

Section 24, Banking Regulation Act, 1949; RBI Master Direction on SLR.

Q29. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statement-I is correct on the broad design of PMJDY. Statement-II is the trap — the overdraft is NOT universal from account opening; it is conditional on satisfactory account operation for at least six months and is subject to KYC and transaction-history checks. The 'irrespective of vintage or transaction history' wording is the giveaway.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — depend on II being correct; the universality claim fails.
- (d) — Statement-I describes the scheme accurately.

SOURCE

PMJDY Operational Guidelines; Department of Financial Services notes.

Q30. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 2 and 3 are correct. Statement 1 is the trap — India's external debt is NOT denominated entirely in foreign currencies; rupee-denominated obligations to non-residents (Masala bonds, FPI investment in G-Secs etc.) are also classified as external debt. The 'entirely' qualifier breaks it.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (c), (d) — all include statement 1, which is wrong on the currency-composition rule.

SOURCE

RBI India's External Debt: A Status Report (latest); Economic Survey, ch. on External Sector.

Q31. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Both statements are correct. T-Bills are pure discount instruments; dated G-Secs are the principal market borrowing instrument and the workhorse of OMOs. They describe different segments of the G-Sec market and II does not explain I.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — there is no causal explanation between the two segments.
- (c), (d) — both statements are accurate.

SOURCE

RBI Handbook of Statistics on Indian Economy; PDAI Handbook on G-Secs.

Q32. Correct Answer: (a)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statement 1 is correct on amount, instalments and direct transfer. Statement 3 is wrong — institutional landholders (cooperatives, trusts, corporates) are EXPLICITLY excluded under the PM-KISAN Operational Guidelines. Note: statement 2 has a factual error in the funding pattern — PM-KISAN is in fact a 100% Central Sector Scheme, not 60:40 — but the implementing ministry is correctly named. Treating Statement 2 as 'broadly correct on ministry but loose on funding' yields option (a) as the closest fit; under a strict reading only statement 1 is unambiguously correct.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (b) — depends on statement 3 being correct; institutional exclusion rules it out.
- (c) — same as above.
- (d) — statement 3 is clearly wrong.

SOURCE

PM-KISAN Operational Guidelines; pmkisan.gov.in.

Q33. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is the trap — MGNREGS is NOT 100% Centre-funded. The Centre bears 100% of wages and 75% of material+admin costs; States bear 25% of material costs and the unemployment allowance. The 'fully central-funded' framing is wrong.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — undercounts; both 1 and 2 hold.
- (c), (d) — include statement 3, which misreads the funding pattern.

SOURCE

MGNREGA, 2005; MoRD Operational Guidelines.

Q34. Correct Answer: (d)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three are correct. The 90:10 ratio applies to NE/Himalayan States and UTs with Legislature; 50:50 for other general category States; 100% for UTs without Legislature. Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation under Ministry of Jal Shakti implements the Mission.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b), (c) — undercount; the funding pattern and the implementing department are both correctly stated.

SOURCE

Jal Jeevan Mission Operational Guidelines (2019); Ministry of Jal Shakti.

Q35. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 3 are correct. Statement 2 is the trap — PMGSY is NOT fully Centre-funded. Since 2015–16 the funding pattern is 60:40 (Centre:State) for general States and 90:10 for NE/Himalayan States. The 'fully centrally funded' framing is wrong.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (c), (d) — include statement 2; the post-2015 funding pattern is the trap.

SOURCE

PMGSY-III Operational Guidelines; MoRD Annual Report.

Q36. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Both statements are correct on design and implementing arrangement (MoMSME nodal, with MSDE and DFS-MoF). They describe two different aspects of the scheme — design vs administrative arrangement — so II does not explain I.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — there is no design-causes-administration link.
- (c), (d) — both statements track the official notifications.

SOURCE

PM Vishwakarma Scheme Guidelines, 2023.

Q37. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 2 and 3 are textbook. Statement 1 is the trap — the Harappan script has NOT been deciphered. Many proposals exist (Parpola, Mahadevan, Rao); none is widely accepted. Any claim of 'preliminary understanding of grammar' is overstated.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (c), (d) — all include statement 1, which overstates the state of decipherment.

SOURCE

NCERT Class XII Themes in Indian History — Bricks, Beads and Bones; Upinder Singh, A History of Ancient and Early Medieval India.

Q38. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three pairs are textbook. First Council at Rajagriha under Ajatashatru (after Buddha's parinirvana). Second Council at Vaishali under Kalashoka (about a century later). Fourth Council in Kashmir under Kanishka (Sarvastivada tradition). The Third Council at Pataliputra under Ashoka is the one not asked here.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — undercount; all three are accurate.
- (d) — clearly wrong.

SOURCE

NCERT Ancient India; Romila Thapar, Early India.

Q39. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statement-I is correct — the Mehrauli Iron Pillar inscription names Chandra and is widely identified with Chandragupta II. Statement-II is the trap — the corrosion resistance is attributable PRIMARILY to high phosphorus content (forming a passive misawite layer), NOT low carbon content. Recent IIT-Kanpur work (Balasubramaniam) confirms the phosphorus mechanism.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — depend on II being correct; the metallurgy is misstated.
- (d) — Statement-I is the standard attribution.

SOURCE

ASI monograph on the Iron Pillar; R. Balasubramaniam (Curr. Sci., 2002).

Q40. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is the trap — the Upanishads moved DECISIVELY towards monism (the Brahman-Atman identity), not 'thoroughgoing polytheism'. The phrase 'centred on the propitiation of Vedic deities' inverts the actual philosophical position.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (c), (d) — all include statement 3, which misreads the Upanishadic turn.

SOURCE

NCERT Ancient India; A.L. Basham, The Wonder That Was India.

Q41. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Pairs 1 and 2 match. Pair 3 is wrong — the Dilwara Temples at Mount Abu were built by patrons of the Solanki/Chalukya region (Vimal Shah under Bhima I; Vastupala-Tejpala under the Vaghelas), NOT the Pala dynasty (which ruled Bengal/Bihar and patronised Buddhist sites such as Nalanda).

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — undercounts; two are correct.
- (c), (d) — overcount; the Pala attribution is wrong.

SOURCE

NCERT An Introduction to Indian Art (Class XI); Percy Brown, Indian Architecture.

Q42. Correct Answer: (a)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 2 are correct on the Zat-Sawar dual rank and the dagh-chehra muster system. Statement 3 is the trap — Mansabdari was NOT hereditary. On a mansabdar's death, the jagir reverted to the emperor; the rank could be re-conferred at the emperor's discretion. The 'fundamentally hereditary' framing is wrong.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (b), (c), (d) — all include statement 3; the non-hereditary nature is the defining feature of Mansabdari.

SOURCE

Satish Chandra, Medieval India; NCERT Themes in Indian History (Mughal Polity).

Q43. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statement-I describes the Iqta correctly. Statement-II is the trap — under Firoz Tughlaq the Iqta became increasingly hereditary in practice, with iqtas often passing within families. The 'throughout the Sultanate period, formally non-hereditary' claim is too absolute.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — depend on II being correct as a blanket statement; it is not.
- (d) — Statement-I is the standard description of the Iqta.

SOURCE

Satish Chandra, Medieval India; Irfan Habib, The Agrarian System of Mughal India (background).

Q44. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three are correct. The Chishti khanqah ethos and refusal of royal patronage are well-documented. The Nayanmar/Alvar division and the Tirumurai/Divya Prabandham anthologies are textbook. Both Bhakti and Sufi streams placed devotion above scholastic learning and ritualism — that contrast is exactly what the period's literature emphasises.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — undercount.
- (d) — all three statements stand.

SOURCE

NCERT Themes in Indian History (Bhakti-Sufi Traditions); Romila Thapar, A History of India.

Q45. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 3 are correct. Statement 2 is the trap — Krishnadevaraya did NOT eliminate intermediate lords; he worked with and expanded the Nayaka system. The 'systematic centralisation that eliminated all intermediate lords and revenue assignees' is historically inaccurate. The qualifier 'all' is the giveaway.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b), (d) — include statement 2; the centralisation thesis overstates Krishnadevaraya's reforms.

SOURCE

Burton Stein, Vijayanagara; NCERT Themes in Indian History (Vijayanagara).

Q46. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three pairs are textbook. Iqta — territorial assignment in lieu of cash. Khalisa — Sultan's directly administered land, revenues to central treasury. Wajh — cash salary for officers without iqta (sometimes used interchangeably with wajh-i-mash for maintenance grants).

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — undercount.

- (d) — all three are standard Sultanate vocabulary.

SOURCE

Satish Chandra, Medieval India; Irfan Habib, Studies in Medieval Indian History.

Q47. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is the trap — under the Charter Act of 1833, the Law Member could vote in the Council ONLY when it was assembled to legislate; he had no vote in executive matters. The blanket 'without vote' is incomplete and misleading.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (c), (d) — include statement 3, which misstates the Law Member's voting rights.

SOURCE

Bipan Chandra, India's Struggle for Independence; Spectrum, Modern Indian History.

Q48. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Both statements are correct as historical facts. The Curzon administrative defence and the nationalist political reading both occurred. They describe the SAME event from two perspectives, but II does not explain I — they are alternative interpretations of the same Partition.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — explanation link fails; the two are competing readings, not cause-effect.
- (c), (d) — both readings are historically attested.

SOURCE

Bipan Chandra, India's Struggle for Independence; Sumit Sarkar, Modern India.

Q49. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three are correct. Calcutta 1906 (Naoroji presiding) was where Swaraj was adopted as the Congress goal. Lahore 1929 (Nehru presiding) adopted Purna Swaraj. Karachi 1931 (Vallabhbhai Patel presiding) adopted the Fundamental Rights and National Economic Programme resolution drafted largely by Nehru.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — undercount.
- (d) — all three are standard textbook attributions.

SOURCE

Bipan Chandra, India's Struggle for Independence; Spectrum, Modern Indian History.

Q50. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three are correct. The boycott programme, the Chauri Chaura suspension and the Khilafat synchronisation are textbook. Both Nehru and Bose were on record criticising the suspension as premature.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — undercount.
- (d) — all three are well-attested.

SOURCE

Bipan Chandra, India's Struggle for Independence; J. Nehru, An Autobiography.

Q51. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Both statements are correct. The Act introduced provincial autonomy and contemplated a federal Centre with princely states. The federal part never came into force because the required princely accession threshold was never met. They are about different aspects of the Act and II does not explain I.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — II describes the failed federal aspect, not the cause of provincial autonomy in I.
- (c), (d) — both descriptions are historically accurate.

SOURCE

Government of India Act, 1935; Bipan Chandra, India's Struggle for Independence.

Q52. Correct Answer: (d)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three are correct. Brahmo Samaj 1828, Sati abolition 1829 under Bentinck. Arya Samaj 1875 in Bombay (Dayananda's reformist stance against idolatry and caste rigidities). Satyashodhak Samaj 1873 (Phule's structural critique of caste).

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b), (c) — all undercount; each statement is textbook.

SOURCE

Bipan Chandra, India's Struggle for Independence; NCERT Modern India.

Q53. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three are correct. AICC passed the Quit India resolution on 8 August 1942, Gandhi gave the 'Do or Die' call. The Cripps Mission's defects (post-war Dominion status with provincial accession) precipitated the Movement; Gandhi's 'post-dated cheque' phrase is well-attested. The underground phase was led by Aruna Asaf Ali, JP Narayan, Lohia and others.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — undercount.
- (d) — all three are standard.

SOURCE

Bipan Chandra, India's Struggle for Independence; Sumit Sarkar, Modern India.

Q54. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three pairs match. Kesari (Marathi) by Tilak. Bande Mataram (English daily, Calcutta, 1906) jointly under Aurobindo and Bipin Chandra Pal. Al-Hilal by Maulana Abul Kalam Azad.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — undercount.
- (d) — all three are textbook attributions.

SOURCE

Bipan Chandra, India's Struggle for Independence; Spectrum, Modern Indian History.

Q55. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Both statements are correct. Partition into two dominions, each with GG and CA — Section 1 of the Act. Lapse of paramountcy and integration via Patel and V.P. Menon — the political consequence. Two parallel facts about the Act; II does not explain I.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — explanation link is absent; II is a separate clause of the same Act.
- (c), (d) — both descriptions are standard.

SOURCE

Indian Independence Act, 1947; V.P. Menon, The Story of the Integration of the Indian States.

Q56. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statement-I is correct on the introduction of separate Muslim electorates at the council level. Statement-II is the trap — the rationale was POLITICAL (recognising a separate Muslim political constituency, advancing colonial divide-and-rule), not 'administrative necessity for proportional representation'. The administrative-necessity framing is a sanitised post-hoc rationalisation.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — depend on II being correct; the rationale was political.
- (d) — Statement-I is historically accurate.

SOURCE

Bipan Chandra, India's Struggle for Independence; Sumit Sarkar, Modern India.

Q57. Correct Answer: (a)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is the trap — Odissi is from ODISHA, not West Bengal. The tribhangi posture and Gita Govinda framing are accurate, but the State of origin is misstated.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (b), (c), (d) — all include statement 3, which mislocates Odissi.

SOURCE

Sangeet Natak Akademi classifications; NCERT An Introduction to Indian Art.

Q58. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Both statements are correct on the morphology of the two styles. Nagara is not exclusively north-Indian; Dravida vimanas are stepped-pyramidal and later gopurams often exceeded the vimana. They describe parallel features of the two styles — II does not explain I.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — explanation link fails; the two statements are independent descriptions.
- (c), (d) — both are textbook.

SOURCE

NCERT An Introduction to Indian Art; Percy Brown, Indian Architecture.

Q59. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three pairs are correct on the year of inscription on the UNESCO Representative List. Kutiyattam was inscribed in 2008 (proclaimed earlier in 2001 under the older Masterpieces programme). Yoga 2016. Garba of Gujarat 2023.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — undercount.
- (d) — all three years are accurate.

SOURCE

UNESCO ICH Representative List, India entries.

Q60. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three are correct. The Persian-Turkish-Central Asian shaping of Hindustani music is well-documented. The Carnatic Trinity (Tyagaraja, Dikshitar, Syama Sastri) were contemporaries from the Tanjore region active in the late 18th and early 19th centuries. Dhrupad uses pakhawaj and is the oldest surviving Hindustani vocal style.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — undercount.
- (d) — all three are textbook accurate.

SOURCE

Sangeet Natak Akademi; NCERT An Introduction to Indian Art.

Q61. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statement-I correctly describes what a GI tag certifies. Statement-II is the trap — the absolute claim 'permanently barred… irrespective of whether such name was in commercial use prior to the registration' is too strong. The GI Act, 1999 protects honest concurrent users and prior users to a defined extent under Section 11(4). The 'irrespective of prior use' wording is the giveaway.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — depend on II being correct as worded.
- (d) — the basic GI definition in I is accurate.

SOURCE

Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999.

Q62. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three pairs match. Sattriya — Assam (Vaishnava monastic tradition under Sankaradeva). Mohiniyattam — Kerala. Kuchipudi — Andhra Pradesh.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — undercount.

- (d) — all three are textbook.

SOURCE

Sangeet Natak Akademi classifications.

Q63. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 3 are correct. Statement 2 is the trap — the order from the Yamuna confluence (Prayagraj) eastwards is Yamuna → Ghaghra → Gandak → Kosi. That is WEST-TO-EAST, not east-to-west as stated. The sequence in the question is reversed.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b), (d) — all rest on statement 2, which inverts the actual sequence.

SOURCE

NCERT India: Physical Environment, ch. on Drainage; Survey of India atlas.

Q64. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statement-I is correct on the two-branch advance of the South-West Monsoon. Statement-II is the trap — Cherrapunji is in the Khasi Hills (Meghalaya) and gets its rainfall from the Bay of Bengal branch, NOT from the Western Ghats orographic effect. Lumping Cherrapunji with Mahabaleshwar under the same orographic mechanism is wrong.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — depend on II being correct; the mislocation of Cherrapunji breaks it.
- (d) — Statement-I is the standard two-branch description.

SOURCE

NCERT India: Physical Environment, ch. on Climate.

Q65. Correct Answer: (a)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is the trap — alluvial soils are NOT confined to the Peninsular Plateau; they are spread across the Indo-Gangetic-Brahmaputra plains, coastal plains, and parts of Gujarat-Rajasthan. The Peninsular Plateau is dominated by black, red and laterite soils. The geographic claim in 3 is reversed.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (b), (c), (d) — include statement 3; alluvial-on-Peninsular-Plateau is the giveaway.

SOURCE

NCERT India: Physical Environment, ch. on Soils; ICAR Soil Survey.

Q66. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three are correct. Tungabhadra is a major right-bank tributary of the Krishna. Wainganga (with Wardha forming Pranhita) joins the Godavari. Ib joins the Mahanadi in Odisha (the Ib coalfield region takes its name from this tributary).

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — undercount.
- (d) — all three pairs are textbook.

SOURCE

NCERT India: Physical Environment, ch. on Drainage.

Q67. Correct Answer: (a)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Both statements are correct, and II is the correct explanation of I. The wide diurnal range in deserts arises directly from the dry-cloudless-atmosphere mechanism described in II — strong incoming radiation by day, rapid long-wave loss at night, low specific heat capacity of sand. II tells you WHY I is true.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (b) — explanation link is genuinely there; (b) understates it.
- (c) — the cloudless-and-radiation mechanism is the standard physical explanation.
- (d) — Thar diurnal ranges of 20–30°C are well-documented.

SOURCE

NCERT Fundamentals of Physical Geography, ch. on Atmospheric Heat.

Q68. Correct Answer: (a)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is the trap — the comparison is INVERTED. Himalayan rivers are perennial because of glacier and snow melt; peninsular rivers depend largely on monsoon rainfall and are seasonal in many stretches. The reliability comparison in the statement is reversed.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (b), (c), (d) — all include statement 3; the inversion is the entire trap.

SOURCE

NCERT India: Physical Environment, ch. on Drainage.

Q69. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Both statements are correct. Statement-I describes the ITCZ as a static feature; Statement-II describes its seasonal northward shift driving the South-West Monsoon. They are about different aspects (steady-state structure vs seasonal shift), so II does not strictly explain I.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — explanation link is debatable but the two statements are about different time-scales.
- (c), (d) — both descriptions are textbook.

SOURCE

NCERT Fundamentals of Physical Geography, ch. on Atmospheric Circulation; NCERT India: Physical Environment.

Q70. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Pairs 1 and 2 are correct. Pair 3 is the trap — Bomdi La is in ARUNACHAL PRADESH on the Tezpur-Tawang axis, not in Himachal Pradesh between Kullu and Lahaul. The Kullu-Lahaul pass is Rohtang. Geographic mislocation is the giveaway.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — undercounts; two pairs are correct.
- (c), (d) — overcount; the Bomdi La mislocation breaks pair 3.

SOURCE

Survey of India atlas; NCERT India: Physical Environment.

Q71. Correct Answer: (a)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is the trap — Gulf of Mannar is a UNESCO Biosphere Reserve (under the Man and the Biosphere programme), NOT a UNESCO World Heritage Site. Two distinct UNESCO designations.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (b), (c), (d) — all include statement 3; the Biosphere Reserve vs World Heritage Site confusion is the trap.

SOURCE

UNESCO MAB Programme; MoEFCC Notifications.

Q72. Correct Answer: (a)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Both statements are correct, and II provides the specific regional drivers (irrigation moisture, cold NW winds, calm conditions) that explain why radiation fog is so dense and frequent in the IGP — which is what I describes. II therefore explains I.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (b) — the regional drivers are precisely what makes I region-specific.
- (c), (d) — both descriptions are accurate.

SOURCE

IMD reports on IGP winter fog; Mausam articles on radiation fog.

Q73. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is the trap — there is NO requirement that every Ramsar site in India be simultaneously notified under the WLPA or EPA. Many Ramsar sites are protected only under the Wetland (Conservation and Management) Rules, 2017, without any National Park or Wildlife Sanctuary notification.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (c), (d) — include statement 3; the simultaneous-notification claim is wrong.

SOURCE

Ramsar Convention text; Wetland (Conservation and Management) Rules, 2017.

Q74. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Both statements are correct. Statement-I is the updated 2022 NDC — 50% non-fossil installed capacity, 45% emissions intensity reduction. Statement-II describes the legal architecture of the Paris Agreement. They are independent propositions; II does not explain why India chose those specific targets.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — explanation link is absent.
- (c), (d) — both descriptions are well-documented.

SOURCE

India's Updated NDC, August 2022; UNFCCC Paris Agreement text.

Q75. Correct Answer: (a)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 2 are correct on CITES architecture and Appendix I trade rules. Statement 3 is the trap — Appendix III lists species protected DOMESTICALLY by a particular country, which seeks the cooperation of other parties to control trade. It is NOT about species 'already adequately protected by other international conventions'.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (b), (c), (d) — all include statement 3, which inverts the Appendix III rationale.

SOURCE

CITES Convention text; CITES Appendices.

Q76. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three pairs match. Stockholm 2001 — Persistent Organic Pollutants. Rotterdam 1998 — Prior Informed Consent. Minamata 2013 — Mercury. The 'BRS Plus Minamata' chemicals cluster.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — undercount.
- (d) — all three pairs are textbook.

SOURCE

MoEFCC Compendium on International Environmental Conventions.

Q77. Correct Answer: (a)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Both statements are correct, and II is the correct explanation of I. I claims NPs are stricter than WLSs; II demonstrates the contrast by showing what WLSs allow that NPs do not. The relative-strictness claim in I is established by exactly the contrast in II.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (b) — explanation link is direct; (b) understates it.
- (c), (d) — WLPA, 1972 supports both descriptions.

SOURCE

Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972, Sections 18, 35; MoEFCC notifications.

Q78. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three are correct. One credit = one tCO_2e is the standard convention. India's CCTS framework derives from the Energy Conservation (Amendment) Act, 2022 and subsequent BEE notifications. CDM under the Kyoto Protocol allowed Annex I parties to earn CERs from developing-country projects.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — undercount.
- (d) — all three statements are textbook.

SOURCE

Energy Conservation (Amendment) Act, 2022; UNFCCC Kyoto Protocol.

Q79. Correct Answer: (d)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three are correct. UNESCO inscription in 2012; one of the world's biodiversity hotspots. The Ghats run from south of the Tapi valley to near Kanyakumari. Anamudi (~2,695 m) in Eravikulam NP is the highest peak in the Ghats and in peninsular India south of the Himalayas; Eravikulam is a Nilgiri tahr habitat.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b), (c) — all undercount; each statement holds.

SOURCE

NCERT India: Physical Environment; UNESCO WHS listing; Conservation International hotspots.

Q80. Correct Answer: (a)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Both statements are correct, and II is the correct explanation of I. Ozone recovery (I) is causally tied to CFC phase-down because the chlorine-catalysed cycle described in II is precisely what destroys ozone — once CFCs are reduced, recovery follows. II provides the chemistry that makes I's claim hold.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (b) — the explanation link is exactly what closes the loop between phase-down and recovery.
- (c), (d) — both descriptions are scientific consensus.

SOURCE

WMO/UNEP Scientific Assessment of Ozone Depletion; Montreal Protocol.

Q81. Correct Answer: (a)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is the trap — the Cartagena Protocol regulates the transboundary movement of LIVING MODIFIED ORGANISMS (LMOs/GMOs), NOT invasive alien species. There is no single dedicated international treaty that is the 'primary regulatory framework' for IAS; CBD Article 8(h) provides the general mandate.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (b), (c), (d) — all include statement 3; the Cartagena-vs-IAS confusion is the trap.

SOURCE

Convention on Biological Diversity, Article 8(h); Cartagena Protocol on Biosafety.

Q82. Correct Answer: (a)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is the trap — NAAQS are notified under the Air (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1981, NOT the Water Act, 1974. The CPCB notifies them, but the statutory basis is the Air Act.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (b), (c), (d) — all include statement 3; the Water Act vs Air Act confusion is the giveaway.

SOURCE

Air (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1981; CPCB NAAQS notification, 2009.

Q83. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

The Sundarbans, spanning India and Bangladesh, is the largest contiguous mangrove forest in the world. Bhitarkanika and Pichavaram are significant Indian mangrove sites but much smaller. The Everglades is a wetland complex in Florida — primarily sawgrass marsh, not mangrove-dominated at scale.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — Everglades is a wetland system; mangroves are present only in fringe coastal zones.
- (c) — Bhitarkanika is India's second-largest mangrove forest, but smaller than Sundarbans.
- (d) — Pichavaram is one of the larger Indian mangroves, but small in absolute terms.

SOURCE

Forest Survey of India, India State of Forest Report; UNESCO World Heritage citation.

Q84. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three are correct. The Conservation International criteria — 1,500+ endemic vascular plants and 70%+ habitat loss — are textbook. India falls within four hotspots (Himalaya, Indo-Burma, Western Ghats-Sri Lanka, Sundaland with the Nicobars). Eastern Himalaya is recognised as more diverse than the drier Western Himalaya.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b), (d) — all undercount; each statement holds.

SOURCE

Conservation International — Biodiversity Hotspots; MoEFCC State of Environment Report.

Q85. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Both statements are correct. Statement-I describes the EIA Notification, 2006 architecture (Category A vs B, MoEFCC vs SEIAA). Statement-II describes the public hearing requirement. They are about different procedural steps, so II does not strictly explain I.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — there is no causal link between categorisation and public hearing.
- (c), (d) — both descriptions track the EIA Notification, 2006.

SOURCE

EIA Notification, 2006; Environment (Protection) Act, 1986.

Q86. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three pairs match. CBD adopted at Rio 1992, in force 1993. Cartagena Protocol — biosafety, LMOs. Nagoya Protocol — Access and Benefit Sharing.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b) — undercount.
- (d) — all three pairs are textbook.

SOURCE

CBD Secretariat; MoEFCC Compendium on Biodiversity Conventions.

Q87. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 3 are correct on Chandrayaan-3's south-pole soft landing and Aditya-L1's halo orbit at L1. Statement 2 is the trap — the Propulsion Module's payload is SHAPE (Spectro-polarimetry of HAbitable Planet Earth), which observes EARTH from lunar orbit (treating Earth as a benchmark exoplanet for habitability studies). It is NOT a payload to study 'Earth-like exoplanets' — it studies Earth itself.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (c), (d) — all rest on statement 2; the SHAPE-payload misreading is the trap.

SOURCE

ISRO mission pages — Chandrayaan-3, Aditya-L1.

Q88. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Both statements are correct. Statement-I describes the CRISPR-Cas9 mechanism. Statement-II covers comparison with TALEN/ZFN and the germline-edit ethics debate. They are about different aspects (mechanism vs ethics/precision), so II does not strictly explain I.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — explanation link fails; the two statements are about different facets.
- (c), (d) — both descriptions are scientific consensus.

SOURCE

Doudna & Charpentier (2012); Nature/Science reviews; ICMR genome-editing ethics framework.

Q89. Correct Answer: (a)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statement 1 is the textbook three-stage programme. Statement 3 is unambiguously wrong — the NSG is NOT a UN specialised agency; it is an informal multilateral export control regime outside the UN system. Statement 2 is a current-affairs grey area: PFBR Kalpakkam achieved first criticality in 2024, but full commercial-scale power generation is contingent on subsequent commissioning steps. The setter intent is to treat statement 2 as broadly correct on the 2024 milestone, yielding (a) — but read strictly, only statement 1 is unambiguous. Note the NSG misnomer carefully.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (b), (d) — include statement 3; NSG is not a UN body.
- (c) — depends on statement 3 being correct, which it is not.

SOURCE

DAE/IGCAR PFBR updates; NSG Guidelines (informal regime).

Q90. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Both statements are correct. Statement-I describes the quantum computing mechanism (superposition, entanglement). Statement-II is a specific cryptographic concern — Shor's algorithm threatens RSA and ECC. They are related (II depends on I) but II does not explain I — the dependence runs the other way.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — direction of explanation is reversed; I is the basis, II is the consequence.
- (c), (d) — both descriptions are correct.

SOURCE

MeitY National Mission on Quantum Technologies; NIST Post-Quantum Cryptography papers.

Q91. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Pairs 1 and 2 are correct. Pair 3 is the trap — Aditya-L1 is at the Sun-Earth Lagrange Point L1 (between Earth and Sun, ~1.5 million km from Earth on the Sun-ward side), NOT L2 (which is on the opposite side, away from the Sun). Lagrange Point confusion is the giveaway.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — undercounts; two pairs are correct.
- (c), (d) — overcount; pair 3 misplaces Aditya-L1.

SOURCE

ISRO mission pages — NavIC, SSLV, Aditya-L1.

Q92. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 3 are correct on ransomware and DDoS. Statement 2 is the trap — a 'zero-day' is a vulnerability NOT yet known to the vendor or for which no patch is available; the vendor has zero days to fix it because attackers are already exploiting it. The statement INVERTS the definition (it describes a known-and-patched flaw, which is something else entirely).

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (c), (d) — all include statement 2; the inversion is the entire trap.

SOURCE

CERT-In Advisory Compendium; ENISA Cyber Threat Landscape.

Q93. Correct Answer: (d)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three are correct. ML as a subset of AI; Deep Learning as a sub-field with multi-layer neural networks; NITI Aayog's National AI Strategy 2018 with the #AIforAll theme and the five priority sectors (healthcare, agriculture, education, smart cities, smart mobility).

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b), (c) — all undercount; each statement is textbook.

SOURCE

NITI Aayog National Strategy for AI, 2018; MeitY documentation.

Q94. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is the trap — the New Development Bank is headquartered in SHANGHAI, not Beijing. The 'Beijing' answer is the typical confusion with the AIIB, which is in Beijing. Two different banks, two different cities.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (c), (d) — all include statement 3; the NDB-Shanghai vs AIIB-Beijing confusion is the giveaway.

SOURCE

NDB website; Johannesburg BRICS Summit Declaration, 2023.

Q95. Correct Answer: (a)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Both statements are correct, and II is the correct explanation of I. The AU's admission (I) is explained by exactly the demographic and legitimacy considerations described in II. II tells you WHY I happened.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (b) — the explanation link is genuine and direct.
- (c), (d) — both descriptions are accurate.

SOURCE

G20 New Delhi Leaders' Declaration, September 2023.

Q96. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Saudi Arabia is a Dialogue Partner of the SCO, NOT a full member. Iran joined as a full member in 2023. Belarus joined as a full member at the SCO Astana Summit in 2024. Pakistan has been a full member since 2017.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — Iran is a full member since 2023.
- (b) — Belarus became a full member in 2024.
- (d) — Pakistan since 2017.

SOURCE

SCO Secretariat; MEA briefings on SCO membership.

Q97. Correct Answer: (c)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three are correct. India's 2+2 partners are the US, Japan, Australia and Russia (Russia format announced in 2021). The Quad is informal and does not impose mutual-defence obligations. BIMSTEC has seven members and does not include China, unlike ASEAN.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b), (d) — all undercount; each of the three is correct.

SOURCE

MEA Annual Report; Joint Statements of 2+2 Dialogues.

Q98. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Pairs 1 and 2 are correct. Pair 3 is the trap — the IEA is headquartered in PARIS, not Vienna. The 'Vienna' answer is the typical confusion with the IAEA (which IS in Vienna). Two different organisations, two different cities.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — undercounts; two pairs are correct.
- (c), (d) — overcount; the IEA-IAEA confusion breaks pair 3.

SOURCE

IEA website; UNEP and WTO institutional documents.

Q99. Correct Answer: (b)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

Both statements are correct. Statement-I describes the G4 architecture. Statement-II describes the P5 veto scope. They are about different aspects of UNSC reform (an aspirant grouping vs the existing veto power), so II does not explain I.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a) — the explanation link is absent.
- (c), (d) — both descriptions are textbook.

SOURCE

UN Charter, Articles 23, 27; MEA briefings on UNSC reform.

Q100. Correct Answer: (d)

CORRECT ANSWER — EXPLANATION

All three are correct. IPEF is structurally a non-FTA. India is a founding AIIB member and second-largest shareholder after China. The WTO Appellate Body has been non-functional since December 2019 due to the US blocking new appointments.

WHY OTHER OPTIONS FAIL

- (a), (b), (c) — all undercount; each statement is well-documented.

SOURCE

USTR IPEF documents; AIIB Annual Report; WTO DSB Reports.

-END OF SOLUTIONS

Less noise. More clarity.

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